

COLLIN WILKINS

Lead Engineer | Distributed Systems | Event-Driven Backend | Cloud

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SUMMARY

Lead engineer with 7 years building software and digital tools, including 5+ years designing and operating distributed, event-driven systems in Java, Kotlin, and Python across AWS, GCP, and Azure. Builds customer-facing backend services, messaging pipelines, and PostgreSQL data workflows for regulated financial services and fleet-scale connected-vehicle platforms. Combines hands-on architecture and production ownership with measurable business outcomes and technical leadership.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Backend: Java, Kotlin, Go (Golang), Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Spring Boot, Node.js, REST APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, microservices

Distributed Systems & Data: Event-driven architecture, Kafka, GCP Pub/Sub, AWS SQS/SNS, PostgreSQL, AWS RDS, NoSQL, MongoDB, Redis, SQL tuning

Cloud & Delivery: AWS Lambda, GCP, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, CloudFormation, Git, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, AWS CodeBuild, AWS CodePipeline

Observability & Security: Splunk, CloudTrail, Grafana, Prometheus, alerting, dashboards, runbooks, incident response, OAuth2/OIDC, SSO/ADFS, RBAC, IAM, TLS

AI Engineering: LLMs, Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot, agent workflows, MCP, prompt engineering, RAG

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Morningstar, Inc.

Lead Engineer

Detroit, MI

2024–Present

- Re-architected a Java compliance-processing engine from manual ECS/Fargate runs to event-driven AWS SQS and Lambda processing, cutting processing volume and time approximately 90% and improving throughput and latency 35%; added independent retries and dead-letter handling adopted by other teams.
- Led architecture and delivery of secure AWS services for regulated financial clients, onboarding 23+ enterprise recordkeepers through OAuth/SSO coordination, deployment planning, and production-readiness reviews.
- Own PostgreSQL and AWS RDS workflows for customer-facing services, including index and query tuning, queue-aware data flows, formal on-call support, and operational controls for regulated production workloads.
- Migrated delivery to AWS CodeBuild and CodePipeline with quality gates, feature flags, environment promotion, and rollback; cycle time improved approximately 20% and defects fell 42%.
- Coordinate event-driven migration across engineering and operations; serve as final pull-request approver and manage production deployments. Mentor five engineers in distributed-systems design and secure delivery; introduced engineering standards, AI-native SDLC training, and a shared agents-and-skills repository.

Ford Motor Company

Full-Stack Software Engineer, Connected Vehicle

Dearborn, MI

2021–2024

- Built Kafka and GCP Pub/Sub consumers ingesting 600K+ vehicle events daily with controls for message reliability, customer-location privacy, and downstream service contracts.
- Built telemetry processing and APIs for a remote dealership inventory-audit platform covering 450K+ vehicles and associated with approximately \$5M in annual savings versus manual audits.
- Designed telemetry-driven theft anticipation and recovery for the 2024 Ford F-150, integrating vehicle event streams, cloud services, and service-to-service messaging for real-time response.
- Built Azure and GCP IoT microservices supporting connected-vehicle telemetry and OTA-adjacent workflows across millions of vehicles under privacy, reliability, and fleet-scale messaging constraints.

Ford Motor Company

Sales Strategy, Business Development & Leadership Roles

Dearborn, MI

2013–2021

- Built digital pricing tools delivering \$2.2M in annual savings; advised 13 dealer accounts representing \$75M AUM and captured \$10M. Completed a three-year rotational leadership program while earning an MBA.

SELECTED PROJECT

Firmware Risk Triage Portal: Built a local proof of capability with Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, and PostgreSQL, including tenant-shaped SBOM and vulnerability models, row-level security, database migrations, and CI security scanning; not deployed to production.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA, Lipscomb University (2016) | **BS, Business Administration, Finance & Accounting**, University of Colorado Boulder (2013)
AWS Cloud Practitioner (2025) | Azure Fundamentals AZ-900 (2024) | Google Kubernetes Engine (2024) | Google Cybersecurity Foundations (2024)